

ケア拒否への 対応

When a Resident Refuses Care — Handling It Gently — Scenario Dialogue

Can-do: Accept a resident's refusal without forcing, find the reason, offer a small easy step, and re-invite gently — protecting trust and dignity.

1 · Dialogue & Why — 会話

Hana
(caregiver)

田中さん、そろそろ お風呂の 時間ですよ。

Tanaka-san, it's about time for your bath.

Why: A normal, gentle prompt — そろそろ ('about time now') 時間[じかん]ですよ ('it's time'). But care must always be offered, never imposed, so when the resident refuses (next line) you respond with patience, not pressure.

Tanaka-san
(resident)

いやよ。今日は 入りたくない。

No. I don't want to bathe today.

Why: いや = 'no / I don't want to'; 入[はい]りたくない = 'don't want to get in' (~たくない = don't want to). A refusal is a valid expression, not 'problem behaviour'. The first rule: STOP. Don't push, don't argue. Consent is the premise of all care.

Hana
(caregiver)

そうでしたか。無理には しませんよ。大丈夫です。

I see. I won't force you. It's okay.

Why: Accept the refusal immediately and out loud: 無理[むり]には しません = 'I won't force it' (無理[むり]に = 'forcibly'). Forcing (無理強[むりじ]い) is counter-productive — it deepens resistance and destroys trust (信頼関係[しんらいかんけい]). Removing the pressure first is what makes a later re-invite possible.

Hana
(caregiver)

何か 気になる ことがありますか。

Is something bothering you?

Why: Now find the reason. 気[き]になる こと = 'something on your mind / bothering you'. Refusal usually has a cause — fear of cold, pain, embarrassment, 'I can do it myself', or confusion (認知症[にんちしょう]). Asking calmly (傾聴[けいちよう] = active listening) lets you solve the real problem.

Tanaka-san
(resident)

寒いのが 嫌なのよ。

I just don't like being cold.

Why: The real reason appears: 寒[さむ]い ('cold') 嫌[いや] ('dislike'). Now you can address it directly instead of pushing. This is why you always ask — the refusal wasn't about the bath, it was about the cold, which you can fix.

Hana
(caregiver)

お部屋を 暖かく しておきますね。先に お湯に 手だけ つけてみませんか。

I'll warm the room up for you. Shall we start by just dipping your hands in the warm water?

Why: Solve the cause (暖[あたた]かくしておきます = 'I'll have it warmed up', ~ておく = do in advance) AND offer a tiny first step: 手[て]だけ ('just your hands') つけてみませんか ('shall we try dipping?'). A small, easy step lowers resistance — once they start, the rest often follows.

Tanaka-san
(resident)

手だけ なら… いいわ。

Just my hands... all right then.

Why: 手[て]だけなら ('if it's just hands') いいわ ('okay') — the small step worked. Never celebrate too loudly or rush; keep it calm and let her keep control of the pace. If she'd still said no, you'd withdraw warmly and try again later — patience over pressure.

Hana
(caregiver)

ありがとうございます。田中さんの ペースで 大丈夫ですよ。

Thank you. At your own pace is just fine.

Why: Thank her (it's her choice, and she gave it) and hand back control: ペースで ('at your pace') 大丈夫[だいじょうぶ] ('is fine'). Respecting the resident's pace and choice preserves 自尊心[じそんしん] (self-esteem) and rebuilds the trust that makes tomorrow's care easier.

2・Key Vocabulary — 語彙

#	日本語	ROMAJI	ENGLISH	メモ / NOTES
1	じかん 時間	jikan	time	
2	ふろ お風呂	ofuro	bath	
3	いや		no; unwilling	
4	～たくない		don't want to ~	
5	むり 無理に	murini	forcibly; against one's will	
6	する		to do	
7	き 気になる	kininaru	to bother; be on one's mind	
8	こと		thing; matter	
9	さむい 寒い	samui	cold	Free video lessons on YouTube · ks-14-care-refusal

10	いや 嫌	<i>iya</i>	dislike; unpleasant	
11	あたたか 暖かい	<i>atatakai</i>	warm	
12	さき 先に	<i>sakini</i>	first; ahead	
13	～なら		if it's ~	
14	いい		good; okay	
15	ペース		pace	
16	だいじょうぶ 大丈夫	<i>daijoubu</i>	okay; fine	

3・Patterns to Reuse — 使える かたち

PATTERN	MEANING & USE
無理[むり]には しませんよ	'I won't force you' — accept refusal, remove pressure first
何[なに]か 気[き]になる ことがありますか	'Is something bothering you?' — find the real cause
先[さき]に ～だけ ～て みませんか	'Shall we start with just ~?' — a small, easy first step
～なら いいわ	'If it's just ~, okay' — how a lowered barrier is accepted
～さんの ペースで 大丈夫[だいじょうぶ]ですよ	'At your own pace is fine' — hand back control

4・Practice — れんしゅう

Say / write it in Japanese, then check with the answer key.

#	SAY THIS IN JAPANESE	YOUR ANSWER
1	Accept the refusal: 'I won't force you. It's okay.'	
2	Find the cause: 'Is something bothering you?'	
3	仕事日本語・Shigoto Nihongo Offer a small step: 'Shall we start with just your hands?'	Free video lessons on YouTube · ks-14-care-refusal

4	Hand back control: 'At your own pace is fine.'	
5	What must you NEVER do when a resident refuses?	

5・Answer Key — こたえ

- 無理^{むり}には しませんよ。大丈夫^{だいじょうぶ}です。
- 何か^{なに} 気^きになる ことがありますか。
- 先^{さき}に お湯^ゆに 手^てだけ つけてみませんか。
- 田中^{たなか}さんの ペースで 大丈夫^{だいじょうぶ}ですよ。
- 無理^{むり}に させること。(Force them.)